

Gender Dynamix New Zealand: Child Protection & Safety Policy

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Child Protection & Safety Policy

1. Purpose

Gender Dynamix New Zealand ("GDNZ") is committed to promoting the safety, wellbeing, dignity and rights of all tamariki and rangatahi who come into contact with our services.

The purposes of this policy are to:

- enable GDNZ workers to prevent and respond to child harm, abuse and neglect;
- set clear expectations for safe recruitment, professional practice, reporting and recordkeeping; and
- support GDNZ to meet its legal and Health NZ contractual obligations.

Protecting children is the responsibility of every person working for or on behalf of GDNZ.

Although 1 in 4 children in Aotearoa are notified to a statutory social worker by age 18 and 1 in 10 experience substantiated abuse, notification alone does not promote wellbeing. Around 60,000 children and young people are recorded each year as present during police callouts for family violence, with most receiving no intervention. This suggests the wider child protection system is not effective at preventing harm or addressing factors contributing to re-victimisation. Child abuse and intimate partner violence continue to have significant and inequitable impacts, and child abuse is a major influence on adult wellbeing.

The consequences of failure to systematically engage the health system in child protection include variable practice, failure to share information, failure to prioritise the needs of the most disadvantaged in Aotearoa, failure to engage with partners to improve outcomes and failure to research solutions.

2. Intended Audience and Scope

This policy applies to all employees, Board members, contractors, volunteers, students and trainees, peer-support workers, clinicians, casual and temporary workers, and anyone else carrying out work for or on behalf of GDNZ.

For the purposes of this policy, **child** means any person under 18 years of age.

This policy applies to direct Service Users and, where relevant, their siblings, children and household members, children encountered through outreach, community or whānau work, and any other child whose safety or wellbeing comes to a GDNZ worker's attention in the course of their work.

3. Our child-protection principles

GDNZ will apply the following principles to all child-protection decisions and activities:

3.1 Safety and wellbeing

The safety and wellbeing of the child or young person will be the primary consideration when responding to child-protection concerns.

Workers will act on concerns rather than assuming that another person or agency will do so.

3.2 Respect and participation

Children and young people will be treated with dignity and respect and, taking account of their age, maturity and circumstances, will be listened to and supported to participate in decisions that affect them.

3.3 Cultural safety

GDNZ recognises the importance of whakapapa, whānau, hapū, iwi, culture, spirituality and identity in the wellbeing of tamariki and rangatahi.

Child-protection practice will be culturally responsive and will seek to uphold the mana of the child and their whānau while making the child's safety the highest priority.

3.4 Trans and gender-diverse young people

Being transgender, non-binary, gender diverse, questioning one's gender, or receiving gender-affirming healthcare is **not in itself a child-protection concern**.

Discrimination, coercion, rejection, violence, exploitation, bullying or other harmful conduct directed at a young person because of their gender identity or expression may, depending on the circumstances, constitute a wellbeing or child-protection concern and must be assessed accordingly.

Information about a young person's gender, gender affirmation, healthcare or other related sensitive information must be treated as confidential health / personal information. It must not be disclosed merely because the person is transgender or gender diverse. Any disclosure must have an appropriate lawful basis and must be limited to information reasonably necessary for the relevant purpose.

3.5 Whānau involvement

GDNZ recognises that safe and supportive whānau can be central to a child's wellbeing.

Whānau should be involved where appropriate and safe. Where informing a parent, guardian, caregiver or whānau member about a child protection matter could increase a safety risk or interfere with a statutory investigation, GDNZ will seek advice from Oranga Tamariki and / or New Zealand Police before doing so.

3.6 Non retaliation

No worker, Service User or other person will be disadvantaged for raising a genuinely held child-safety concern in good faith.

4. Definitions

Abuse

For this policy, abuse includes actual or potential:

- physical abuse
- sexual abuse or exploitation
- emotional or psychological abuse
- coercion
- family or intimate-partner violence affecting a child

- financial exploitation
- grooming
- neglect or deprivation
- other conduct that causes or creates a significant risk of harm to a child

Abuse may occur within or outside a child's family or whānau and may be perpetrated by adults or other children or young people.

Child / te tamaiti / tamariki

Any child or young person who is under the age of 18 years. For the purpose of this policy this includes the unborn.

Child protection

The activities carried out to ensure that children are safe in cases where there is suspected abuse or neglect or the risk of abuse or neglect. It also recognises the role that Gender Dynamix plays in promoting the wellbeing of children and responding to their vulnerability.

Child protection concern

Any information, observation, disclosure, allegation, pattern of behaviour or other circumstance giving rise to concern regarding the safety or wellbeing of a child.

Proof of abuse is not required before a concern is raised internally or discussed with Oranga Tamariki or Police.

Children's services

Are any of the following:

1. services provided to 1 or more children
2. services to adults in respect of 1 or more children
3. services provided to adults living in households that include 1 or more children, and that do or may affect significantly any one or more aspects of the well-being of those children

Children's Worker

A Children's Worker is defined in accordance with the Children's Act 2014. A children's worker is a person, whether paid or unpaid, working in or providing a Regulated Service whose work involves or may involve regular or overnight contact with a child without the child's parent or guardian present.

Children's Workers will be classified as **core** or **non-core** in accordance with the Children's Act 2014.

Emotional abuse

Emotional abuse is when the psychological, social, intellectual and emotional functioning or development of te tamaiti or rangatahi has been damaged by their treatment by their parents, caregivers or whānau or family.

Family Violence

The emotional, psychological and physical wellbeing of te tamaiti can be affected when they're exposed to family violence. See [Meaning of family violence — section 9 of Family Violence Act 2018](#).

GDNZ / Gender Dynamix New Zealand

"GDNZ" refers to "Gender Dynamix New Zealand", also known as "Gender Dynamix of Aotearoa" and "Gender Dynamix". All can be read interchangeably.

Neglect

Neglect is a failure to provide for a child's basic physical, emotional, health, developmental, educational or safety needs to an extent that causes, or creates a significant risk of, harm. This harm includes (but is not limited to) abuse of the child.

Oranga Tamariki / Ministry for Children

Government agency that carries out the legislative requirements of the Oranga Tamariki Act 1989. Responsibilities include investigating cases of child harm, abuse and / or neglect, providing care and protection for children found to be in need, and more.

Physical abuse

Any act or acts that may result in physical harm to a child.

Service Users

Service User means any person who receives GDNZ services, or is referred to GDNZ. For the purposes of this policy, this includes children who are direct recipients of services and may also include people whose circumstances are relevant to the safety or wellbeing of a child in connection with GDNZ's services.

Sexual abuse

Involves forcing or enticing a child to take part in sexual activities, regardless of whether they understand or consent.

Worker

A GDNZ employee, intern, student on placement, volunteer, contractor or subcontractor.

5. Governance and responsibilities

5.1 The Board

The Board approves this policy, ensures appropriate resources and oversight, receives assurance that safety-checking and Health NZ requirements are being met, monitors material child-protection risks and serious incidents, and ensures the policy is reviewed on time. The Board should not operationally involve itself except for serious incidents (e.g. where there is systematic failures to comply with the Policy or Health NZ Contract) and in so far as the reasonably are required to monitor protection risk.

5.2 Designated Person for Child Protection (Clinical Lead)

GDNZ will appoint a Designated Person for Child Protection (DPCP). This will typically be the Clinical Lead.

The DPCP provides advice and coordinates GDNZ's response to concerns and disclosures, including external reports and Health NZ notifications; oversees child-protection records, safety-checking and training; keeps current with relevant guidance; coordinates policy reviews; and reports material risks and assurance to the Board. The DPCP also ensures workers understand and can apply this policy and work with the Operations Manager to ensure an understanding of this policy is part of worker induction and workers' ongoing professional development.

The DPCP does not replace an individual worker's responsibility to act where a child may be unsafe.

5.3 Operations Manager

The Operations Manager ensures workers have access to a copy of this policy, supports workers raising concerns, escalates concerns promptly, embeds child-protection requirements in recruitment, induction, practice and performance management, and acts where worker behaviour may create a risk to a child.

5.4 All workers

Every worker must:

- be familiar with this policy and comply with it
- complete required child-protection training as appropriate to their role
- remain alert to indicators of harm, abuse and neglect
- respond appropriately to disclosures
- promptly raise concerns with the appropriate professionals
- accurately and promptly document concerns and actions
- cooperate with statutory agencies and authorised investigations
- maintain professional boundaries and safe practice

No worker is expected to investigate suspected child abuse themselves.

All workers should raise any concerns immediately with the DPCP who will assist, guide, and coordinate reporting to relevant authorities. If the worker has any concerns that raising this to the DPCP may in some way negatively impact the safety of the child or another person they should immediately contact the Board Chair (boardchair@gdnz.org).

6. Safer recruitment and Children's Worker safety checking

GDNZ will identify every role that constitutes a Children's Worker role and record whether it is a core or non-core Children's Worker role.

6.1 Checks before work begins

No person will be permitted to undertake Regulated Services as a Children's Worker until all required Children's Act and any contractually required Safety Checks have:

1. been completed
2. been assessed
3. resulted in a satisfactory safety-risk assessment

The safety-checking process will include the checks required by current legislation and regulation. Safety Checks will include Police vetting, identity confirmation, interviews, referee checking, relevant professional-registration checking and a risk assessment.

6.2 Periodic checks

Children's Worker Safety Checks must be repeated at least every **three years** from the most recent Safety Check.

GDNZ will maintain a central register recording:

- worker name
- role
- core / non-core classification
- date initial check completed
- components of the check completed
- date Police vet completed
- risk-assessment decision
- person approving the assessment
- next recheck date
- any relevant restrictions or conditions
- Health NZ Compliance Declaration status

6.3 Compliance declarations

GDNZ will provide Health NZ with Children's Worker Compliance Declarations in the form and at the intervals required by Health NZ.

A new worker, or a person who has previously been excluded because their Safety Check was incomplete or unsatisfactory, must not provide Regulated Services until:

- satisfactory Safety Checks have been completed
- where required under the Health NZ contract, an up-to-date Compliance Declaration has been provided to Health NZ

7. Safe working practices and professional boundaries

Workers must maintain clear professional boundaries with children and young people.

GDNZ recognises that clinical and peer-support services may legitimately involve one-to-one contact. One-to-one work is therefore not prohibited, but it must occur within an appropriate professional framework.

Workers must:

- conduct contact in approved service environments or through approved communication systems wherever practicable
- ensure appointments / interactions are appropriately documented
- use GDNZ approved accounts, devices and communication channels for service delivery
- not establish sexual or exploitative relationships with a child
- use physical contact only where clinically appropriate, consented to where applicable, or reasonably required to protect immediate safety

Promptly communicate with the DPCP about any situation in which boundaries with a service user have become unclear.

8. Recognising possible abuse or neglect

Workers should remain alert to indicators of possible abuse or neglect.

Indicators of Abuse

Oranga Tamariki states that indicators of abuse may include:

- Physical signs (e.g., unexplained injuries, burns, fractures, unusual or excessive itching, genital injuries, sexually transmitted diseases).
- Behavioural concerns (e.g., age-inappropriate sexual interest or play, fear of a certain person or place, eating disorders/substance abuse, disengagement/neediness, aggression).
- Developmental delays (e.g., small for their age, cognitive delays, falling behind in school, poor speech and social skills).
- Emotional abuse/neglect (e.g., sleep problems, low self-esteem, obsessive behaviour, inability to cope in social situations, sadness/loneliness and evidence of self-harm).

Indicators of neglect

Oranga Tamariki states that indicators of neglect may include:

- Physical signs (e.g., looking rough and uncared for, dirty, without appropriate clothing, underweight).
- Behavioural concerns (e.g., disengagement/neediness, eating disorders/substance abuse, aggression).
- Developmental delays (e.g., small for their age, cognitive delays, falling behind in school, poor speech and social skills).
- Neglectful supervision (e.g., out and about unsupervised, left alone, no safe home to return to).
- Emotional abuse/neglect (e.g., sleep problems, low self-esteem, obsessive behaviour, inability to cope in social situations, sadness/loneliness and evidence of self-harm).
- Medical neglect (e.g., persistent nappy rash or skin disorders or other untreated medical issues).

Workers should recognise that family violence or intimate-partner violence and child harm may co-occur. Where one is identified or suspected, workers should consider whether there are associated risks to children or other members of the household.

An indicator is not necessarily proof of abuse or neglect. Workers must consider context and avoid assumptions or stereotyping. Concerns should be discussed and assessed rather than dismissed..

9. Responding to a disclosure or child-protection concern

9.1 Immediate danger

Where a worker believes a child is in current or imminent danger:

Call New Zealand Police on 111 immediately.

The worker must then notify the DPCP as soon as practicable.

Call Police on 111 where a child is in immediate danger.

9.2 When a child makes a disclosure

The worker should:

- remain calm
- listen carefully
- take the child seriously
- reassure the child that they have done the right thing by speaking
- make clear that they are not in trouble
- allow the child to speak in their own words
- use only minimal, open prompts where necessary, for example, "What happened next?";
- not conduct an interview or investigation
- not ask leading questions
- not challenge or confront the alleged person responsible
- not promise absolute confidentiality or promise an outcome that cannot be guaranteed
- explain, in an age-appropriate way, that the worker may need to share the information with people who can help keep them safe
- take whatever immediate steps are reasonably necessary to maintain safety
- manage the matter with respect and sensitivity

Official guidance recommends listening, reassurance, open-ended prompts rather than interviewing, and prompt factual recording.

If child harm, abuse and or neglect is identified or suspected, then a plan is required for ensuring the safety of the child or for providing help and support to the family. An experienced colleague (generally this would be the DPCP as the first point of contact), specialist child protection staff or the duty social worker at Oranga Tamariki (on 0508 326 459) should be promptly consulted with to make this plan. Workers can consult with more senior colleagues at any additional time regarding their concerns.

9.3 Record the concern

As soon as practicable, the worker must make a factual written record including:

- the date and time
- where the disclosure or concern arose
- who was present

- the child's words as accurately and, where important, as close to verbatim as possible
- relevant observations
- factual information giving rise to concern
- any immediate action taken
- who was notified
- advice received
- referrals or reports made
- any follow-up required

Workers must distinguish clearly between:

- what was observed
- what another person said
- the worker's professional assessment or opinion

Child-protection records must not be altered to retrospectively improve or reinterpret the original account. Any subsequent information should be separately dated and recorded.

9.4 Internal escalation

The worker must notify the DPCP **as soon as possible and on the same day**.

If the concern relates to the DPCP, or if there is reasonable grounds to believe the DPCP has a conflict of interest, it must instead be reported to the Board Chair (boardchair@gdnz.org).

If the DPCP or Board Chair cannot be promptly reached and delay may place a child at risk, the worker must contact Oranga Tamariki and / or Police promptly.

Internal escalation must never be used as a reason to delay urgent external reporting.

Workers do not need to seek family/whānau permission to consult with colleagues but should advise family/whānau of this unless doing so creates further risk.

9.5 Report of concern to Oranga Tamariki or Police

Section 15 of the Oranga Tamariki Act 1989 allows any person who believes a child or young person has been, or is likely to be, harmed, ill-treated, abused, neglected or deprived to report the matter to Oranga Tamariki or Police.

A worker's decision about whether to make a report of concern to Oranga Tamariki or Police should be made in consultation with the DPCP wherever possible and appropriate to do so. The worker holding the child protection concern is to make the report of concern to Oranga Tamariki and/or Police themselves following any such consultation. Following consultation, the DPCP can assist the worker with the reporting process.

All suspected child harm, abuse or neglect must be reported promptly to Oranga Tamariki, and to New Zealand Police where appropriate. This is an organisational requirement and does not require a worker to prove that abuse or neglect has occurred before making a report.

Workers do not need to seek family/whānau permission to consult with Oranga Tamariki but should do so, as standard practice, unless doing so creates further risk to the child and/or others.

Oranga Tamariki – Report of Concern:

0508 326 459 – available 24 hours a day, 7 days a week

A report may also be submitted through Oranga Tamariki's official online Report of Concern service.

Where the concern involves immediate danger or suspected criminal offending requiring an urgent Police response, Police must be contacted.

Workers do not need to prove that abuse has occurred before raising a concern or contacting Oranga Tamariki for advice.

9.6 Informing parents, caregivers or whānau

Workers must not automatically inform a parent, caregiver or other whānau member of a report or concern.

The DPCP will consider whether this is appropriate, having regard to:

- the child's safety
- the child's views and circumstances
- whether the alleged source of harm is within the family / whānau
- the risk of retaliation, coercion or further harm to the child and/or others (including staff)
- privacy and confidentiality
- and advice from Oranga Tamariki and / or Police

Where statutory agencies are involved, GDNZ will coordinate communication with them to avoid compromising an investigation or increasing risk to the child.

10. Mandatory contractual notification to Health NZ

In addition to any report to Oranga Tamariki or Police, GDNZ has a separate contractual obligation to immediately notify Health NZ:

- if this Child Protection Policy is breached
- if an incident relating to the safety, wellbeing or protection of a child occurs or is suspected

The Provider must also actively engage with Health NZ to promptly address risks and agree and implement appropriate mitigation measures.

The DPCP is responsible for ensuring this notification occurs.

The notification and Health NZ's response must be recorded in the child-protection incident file.

11. Allegations or concerns about a worker

Any allegation that an a GDNZ worker has harmed, abused, neglected, groomed or otherwise acted inappropriately towards a child must be treated seriously.

The following actions will be taken:

1. If the worker has this concern, they should immediately contact Oranga Tamariki or Police.
The safety of any child is the highest priority.

2. Notify the DPCP and Operations Lead. If the allegation concerns the DPCP or Operations Lead, the matter must be escalated the Board Chair (boardchair@gdnz.org).
3. Report externally where required. Oranga Tamariki and / or Police will be contacted in accordance with section 9 of this policy.
4. Notify Health NZ immediately.
5. Preserve evidence and records. GDNZ will not conduct questioning or investigative activity that could compromise a Police or Oranga Tamariki investigation.
6. Manage employment or contractual risk. GDNZ may remove the worker from contact with children, temporarily alter duties or consider suspension where appropriate, while complying with employment law, contractual obligations, natural justice and good-faith requirements.
7. Maintain appropriate confidentiality. Information will be limited to those who need it for safety, statutory, governance or employment purposes.

An internal employment investigation is distinct from a child-protection or Police investigation and will be appropriately coordinated with statutory agencies.

Settlement agreements

GDNZ will not use a settlement agreement to avoid appropriately addressing a child-safety allegation, including an agreement under which a worker resigns on condition that disciplinary action is discontinued and an agreed future reference is provided.

12. Confidentiality, privacy and information sharing

Child-protection information is sensitive information and must be handled in accordance with:

- the Privacy Act 2020
- the Health Information Privacy Code 2020 where applicable
- the Oranga Tamariki Act 1989
- GDNZ Health NZ contract/s
- GDNZ's Privacy Policy
- GDNZ's Records Management and Information Security requirements

Confidentiality does not mean that child-safety concerns must remain secret.

Information may be shared where there is a lawful basis to do so and sharing is reasonably necessary to protect a child, make or support a report of concern, comply with a statutory obligation, or comply with GDNZ's Health NZ contractual obligations.

13. Child-protection records

GDNZ will maintain secure records of child protection related:

- disclosures and concerns
- child-protection assessments
- discussions and decisions
- reasons for decisions, including decisions not to make an external report

- reports to Oranga Tamariki and Police
- Health NZ notifications
- advice received from statutory agencies
- actions and safety plans
- follow-up activity
- related correspondence

Where the child is a GDNZ Service User, child-protection concerns and relevant actions must also be appropriately documented in the Service User's clinical or service record, subject to GDNZ's privacy, security and record-access requirements.

Records should allow apparently separate concerns relating to the same child or household to be identified where lawful and appropriate, because cumulative concerns may reveal patterns not apparent from a single event.

Records should be retained of notes from the original concern, related discussions, advice received, actions taken and the rationale for decisions.

Records must be retained and disposed of in accordance with GDNZ's records management and retention requirements and applicable health-information retention requirements.

14. Training and supervision

All relevant workers must receive child-protection and family violence intervention training:

- as part of induction before or as soon as practicable after beginning relevant duties
- at least every two years throughout their tenure

Training must enable workers to, as appropriate to their role:

- recognise possible indicators of abuse or neglect
- respond appropriately to disclosures
- understand this policy
- understand how and when to escalate concerns
- understand the Oranga Tamariki and Police reporting pathways
- understand GDNZ's Health NZ notification requirement
- make factual and appropriate records
- understand professional boundaries and safe practice
- understand their privacy and information-sharing responsibilities

GDNZ will maintain a training register showing completion and next-due dates.

Child-protection issues should also be available for discussion through appropriate clinical or management supervision.

Workers involved responding to child protection concerns will have access to appropriate clinical or management supervision, debriefing, peer support and other available wellbeing support. Managers will ensure support is offered promptly following significant or distressing child-protection events.

15. Monitoring and assurance

GDNZ will maintain sufficient evidence to demonstrate compliance with this policy.

At minimum, the organisation will maintain:

- a current Child Protection Policy
- a Children's Worker role / classification register
- complete Safety Check records
- a three-yearly recheck schedule for this policy
- Health NZ Compliance Declarations
- a child-protection training register
- records of child-protection incidents and concerns
- records of Health NZ notifications
- records of referrals / reports to statutory agencies where relevant
- records of corrective and preventive actions
- evidence of policy review and Board approval

Health NZ may request Safety Check records, compliance declarations and other supporting documents, and may audit compliance with these requirements.

The DPCP will report to the Board at least annually on implementation of this policy and child-protection assurance. This annual report will constitute GDNZ's formal review of policy implementation and will include appropriate assurance metrics, including:

- training compliance
- Safety Check compliance
- upcoming rechecks
- number and broad nature of incidents or concerns, appropriately anonymised
- notifications made to Health NZ
- relevant policy or process improvements
- any material outstanding risks

16. Breaches of this policy

Any known or suspected breach of this policy must be promptly escalated to the DPCP or, where appropriate, the Operations Manager or Board Chair.

Immediate action will be taken where necessary to protect a child.

Note that GDNZ's Health NZ contract requires immediate notification where the child-protection policy is breached, the DPCP must ensure Health NZ is notified without delay.

A breach by a worker may additionally be addressed under applicable employment, contractual, professional or disciplinary processes (noting the settlement restrictions ("settlement agreements") in section 11 of this policy).

17. Policy review

This policy will be formally reviewed:

- at least once every three years
- following a serious child-protection incident where lessons may require policy change
- following a material change to legislation, regulation or Health NZ requirements
- where an audit process identifies a gap
- earlier if the Board or DPCP considers review necessary

The child-protection policy must be reviewed within three years of its adoption or most recent review and to remain current throughout the period in which Children's Services are provided.

GDNZ will also check this policy against the current **Health NZ National Child Protection Policy and associated checklists** whenever Health NZ issues or updates those requirements.

Appendices

Appendix A: Quick Response Guide

A child is in immediate danger

Call Police – 111

Then:

1. Make the child as safe as reasonably possible
2. Notify the DPCP (unless this is not advisable - see section 11 of this policy)
3. Document what happened
4. Notify Health NZ immediately. Wherever possible, this action should typically be completed by the DPCP.
5. Cooperate with Police / Oranga Tamariki

A child discloses abuse or neglect

1. Listen
2. Reassure
3. Do not investigate
4. Use only minimal open prompts
5. Record the child's words
6. Notify and consult with the DPCP (unless this is not appropriate - see sections 9.4 and 11 of this policy)
7. Report of suspected child harm, abuse or neglect is made to Oranga Tamariki (or Police where appropriate). The reporting should be done by the worker holding the concern. The DPCP is to assist the worker with this reporting, following the worker's consultation with them.
8. Notify Health NZ immediately where the incident falls within the contractual requirement. This action should typically be completed by the DPCP.
9. Record all actions.

You observe or receive information creating a child-safety concern

1. Record the facts
2. Consult with the DPCP promptly to evaluate the situation, unless this is not advisable (see sections 9.4 and 11 of this policy), or unless you are unable to reach them in a sufficiently prompt timeframe.
3. Consider cumulative information (see section 13 of this policy), if possible with the DPCP.
4. Report suspected child harm, abuse or neglect to Oranga Tamariki (and Police where appropriate). If possible, obtain assistance from the DPCP with this.
5. Implement a safety plan for the child. This should be done by, or in consultation with, the DPCP wherever possible.
6. Make a Health NZ notification where contractually required. Where possible this should be done by the DPCP.

Oranga Tamariki Report of Concern

0508 326 459 – 24 hours a day, 7 days a week

Immediate danger

New Zealand Police – 111

Appendix B – Child Protection Concern Record

For every child-protection concern, record:

- Date / time concern raised:
- Date / time incident occurred, if known:
- Child's name:
- Child's date of birth / age, if known:
- Relevant contact details:
- Person completing record:
- Location:
- People present:
- What was observed:
- What the child / person said, using exact words where possible:
- Relevant previous concerns:
- Immediate safety risks identified:
- Immediate action taken:
- DPCP / manager notified:
 - Date / time notified:
 - Advice received:
- Oranga Tamariki contacted:
 - Date / time / reference:
- Police contacted:
 - Date / time / reference:
- Health NZ notified:
 - Date / time / person notified:
 - Contract number C6262 included:
- Parent / caregiver / whānau informed:
 - If yes, by whom and when:
 - If no, rationale:
- Follow-up actions:
- Responsible person:
- Due date:
- Date case reviewed / closed:
- Closure rationale:

Appendix C – Children's Worker Safety Check Register

A 'new worker' Children's Worker Safety Check needs to be done on new workers to Gender Dynamix, and any existing workers at Gender Dynamix who have not yet had a new worker check done (for instance due to a change of their role). This is the case even if a worker has had a new worker check done by a previous employer, educational body, or other organisation.

After their 'new worker' check, a 'periodic' Children's Worker Safety Check needs to be done on a worker every 3 years.

A new worker check is more extensive than a periodic check. Please see the latest version of the Children's (Requirements for Safety Checks of Children's Workers) Regulations 2015 for further details.

All current and past Children's Worker Safety Checks for workers should be stored for as long as legally indicated (do not simply delete a previous check, or documentation of a previous check, when doing a periodic check 3 years later).

For each relevant worker, clear written documentation of the following needs to be stored by Gender Dynamix (in a manner that is secure, but with all documentation readily locatable)

- Worker's full name
- Evidence of the worker's right to work in New Zealand
- Any name change documentation, if relevant
- Position/s
- Employment / engagement type/s
- Signed employment agreement/s
- Job description/s
- Employment start date/s
- Any employment end date/s
- Children's Worker: Yes / No
- Core / non-core (for each check done)
- Identity confirmed (verified proof of identity, either via RealMe or certified copies of primary and secondary identity documents, as per Children's (Requirements for Safety Checks of Children's Workers) Regulations 2015)
- Risk assessment interview completed
- Risk assessment reference/s completed
- Chronological work history of the 5 years preceding the initial Children's Worker Safety Check done by the organisation (including description of previous employment positions)
- Professional registration verified, if applicable
- Any relevant current professional organisational membership, or name of any licensing authority that has issued a current licence to the person for the carrying on of a particular activity that is relevant to the person's employment or engagement, or proposed employment or engagement
- The worker's written consent to each police vetting completed
- NZ Police vetting completed - date/s of completion

- NZ Police vetting completed - outcome/s
- Any overseas police certificate or overseas background check material obtained
- Other required checks
- Documented written risk assessment and date of this being completed
- The decision that the worker is suitable to perform the role.
- Approved by
- Safety Check completion date
- Next Safety Check due date
- Compliance Declaration required
- Compliance Declaration sent to Health NZ
- Date sent
- Any restrictions / conditions
- Evidence location

Appendix D – Related Documents

This policy should be read alongside GDNZ's:

- Health NZ contract C6262 and applicable Service Specifications
- GDNZ's other Policies
- Relevant New Zealand law (e.g. the Privacy Act 2020, the Health Information Privacy Code, the Oranga Tamariki Act 1989)

Approval History

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Policy owner: Clinical Lead (Designated Person for Child Protection)

Approved by: Board of Trustees of Gender Dynamix New Zealand

Approval date: 9 September 2026

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Health NZ contract: C6262

Designated Person for Child Protection: Clinical Lead: cppcontact@gdnz.org

Alternate Designated Person: Board Chair: boardchair@gdnz.org